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DETAIL SPECIFICATION
MANUALS, TECHNICAL - STRUCTURAL REPAIR (AIRCRAFT)



Comments, suggestions, or questions on this document should be addressed to AFLCMC/GBS Technical Data Section, 1865 4th Street, Bldg 14, Room 32, Area B, Wright-Patterson AFB, OH 45433 or emailed to SGMLsupport@us.af.mil. Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this address information using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

AMSC 10511 **AREA TMSS**

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This specification is approved for use by the Department of the Air Force and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1 SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for the preparation of technical manuals containing aircraft structural repair instructions, excluding battle damage repair. This specification provides for electronic delivery of data through the use of the tagged language tools as specified in Appendix A.

2 APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 General. The documents listed in this section are specified in sections 3 and 4 of this specification. This section does not include documents cited in other sections of this specification or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements of documents cited in sections 3 and 4 of this specification, whether or not they are listed.

2.2 Government documents.

2.2.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE SPECIFICATIONS

MIL-DTL-83495	-	Manuals, Technical - On-equipment Maintenance Manual Set

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE STANDARDS

MIL-STD-1808	-	System Subsystem Sub-subsystem Numbering
MIL-STD-38784	-	General Style and Format Requirements for Technical Manuals

(Copies of these documents are available online at https://quicksearch.dla.mil.)

3 REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preparation. The general manner of preparation of the basic structural repair manual and battle damage data, when required, shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-38784. System Subsystem Sub-subsystem Numbering (SSSN) shall be developed in accordance with MIL-STD-1808.

3.1.1 Security classification. When possible, the contents of the documents shall be so arranged and worded that they shall be unclassified. However, if classified information is required, it shall be prepared in accordance with MIL-STD-38784.

3.1.2 Margin data SSSN placement. When structural repair manuals will be used in conjunction with On-equipment Maintenance Manual Sets (OMMS) prepared in accordance with MIL-DTL-83495, place the SSSN in accordance with MIL-STD-38784.

3.1.3 Nomenclature. When SSSNs are used, vehicle equipment nomenclatures excluding structural components shall be followed by the applicable higher level reference designation in parenthesis. Manual titles, chapter titles, and system/subsystem nomenclatures shall be followed by the applicable SSSN in parenthesis.

3.2 Basic structural repair manual. The extent of coverage shall be as follows:

3.2.1 Content. The structural repair manual shall contain information required by maintenance personnel for determining the extent of damage to the aircraft structure and instructions for its repair that are not contained in general manuals for structural repair and other general repair manuals.

3.2.1.1 Covered repairs. When repairs covered in the general repair manuals are acceptable for the applicable aircraft, it shall be so stated and referenced in the appropriate chapter of the manual. If the information in the general

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repair manuals is unacceptable, the aircraft manual shall contain the proper information as the aircraft manual will take precedence over the general manual.

3.2.1.2 New or peculiar structures. Repair instructions for new or peculiar structures, such as tapered skin, sandwich materials, honeycomb assemblies, reinforced plastics, and composite materials shall be included in the manual if they are not covered in the general repair manuals. Coverage of structural components of pods and external tanks shall also be provided.

3.2.1.3 Detail. Repairs contained shall be as simple as possible and practical (considering accessibility, adjacent structures, etc.). Wherever practical, repairs shall require only hand tools. The use of jigs, machine tools, etc., and rivets requiring heat treatment before driving, shall be specified when necessary.

3.2.1.4 Repairs involving extrusion. When a covered repair involves the use of an extrusion, an alternate repair, utilizing sheet, bar, or tubing, instead of extrusion shall also be shown, when practical.

3.2.1.5 New types or classes of material. When the original design of the aircraft is modified to incorporate new types or classes of material, an alternate repair, if practical, shall be included based on using the more common materials generally available.

3.2.1.6 Removal and installation instructions. Removal and installation instructions shall be included for all structures beyond organizational and intermediate level maintenance that is not included in the organizational maintenance manual.

3.2.1.7 Corrosion control information. Corrosion control information shall be included when a separate corrosion control manual is not being procured (see 6.2.b). When a separate corrosion control manual is being procured, references to the corrosion control manual shall be included.

3.2.1.8 Special repair instructions. Instructions for one-time (ferry) flight repairs, temporary repairs, critical area repairs, and combat area repairs shall include information of flight restrictions to be imposed (if applicable) until such time as permanent repairs have been completed.

3.2.2 Damage. Classification shall be as follows: negligible damage, repairable damage, crash damage, and combat area damage.

3.2.2.1 Defining classes of damage. Each class of damage shall be clearly defined, with examples cited, for each component of the major structural groups covered by the structural group repair chapters in the manual. The definitions of each class of damage for a component shall appear in the chapter of the manual covering the component.

3.2.3 Repairs. The scope of the repairs to the various components shall provide for the repair of any repairable damage in any location. Definitive statements regarding repair decisions shall be made to preclude misinterpretation and indecision in connection with typical repairs. Cautions shall be included to prohibit unauthorized repairs and materials. Where the loads, material thickness, and margin of safety vary, a table indicating the station, material, thickness, fastener, diameter, number of fastener rows, fastener spacing, doubler overlap, and bonding requirements, extent of allowable damage, and information regarding reinforcement data to transfer design loads, shall be provided. Where the loads do not vary, typical loads and minimum design loads for tension, compression, and shear shall be shown.

3.2.3.1 Description of repairs. The description of repairs shall be complete and show compliance with all relevant design requirements. The repair shall be such as to make the strength of the repaired structure equal to or greater than that required. It shall also maintain the structural capability of the aircraft with due considerations to stiffness and thermal problems. Illustrations of the members of components showing where the various types of repairs are to be employed shall be given and the areas where each type is to be used shall be indicated by shading or other appropriate means. When a combination of two or more repairs will weaken or over stiffen the member beyond the safe limit, the combination shall be indicated as prohibited and a caution shall be given to prohibit such a combination. All specific repairs shall be identified by part numbers.

3.2.3.2 Use of standard parts. Whenever possible, government standard parts shall be specified for use in repair or replacement. References in the manual to these parts shall be by the applicable government standard part designation.

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3.2.4 Illustrations. In addition to the illustrations specified in 3.2.3.1, the following illustrations, diagrams, and charts shall be included in the manual with as many additions as required to illustrate detailed repair of the aircraft. Illustrations shall be located as close as possible to the related text.

3.2.4.1 Front view. A three-quarter front view illustration in exploded form, indexing all major structural groups, shall be placed in Chapter 1.

3.2.4.2 Chapter 1. Diagram(s) shall be provided in Chapter 1 identifying the airplane stations by number. Numbers shall be identified with the stations by use of connecting lines.

3.2.4.3 Major structural groups. The manual shall include an illustration of each major structural group in the applicable repair chapter. This illustration shall be indexed to show the location of the repair index of each component. Component repair index illustrations shall be coded and an accompanying table shall indicate, as applicable, the index number, major or subassembly drawing number, description, size, gauge, material, heat treatment, and reference to the repair illustrations.

3.2.4.4 Principal symmetry check dimensions. Diagrams(s) shall be provided showing the principal symmetry check dimensions and permissible field variations. These variations shall never be less than the original manufacturing tolerances. Measurements shall be taken from clearly defined points which may be easily located and identified in the field. Diagrams and text shall also be provided giving alignment check data for landing gear, wing, stabilizers, etc., to ensure proper aerodynamic performance.

3.2.4.5 Leveling of aircraft. An illustration shall be included clearly showing and identifying the special points used in leveling the aircraft transversely and longitudinally. Leveling tools shall be described and illustrated, as necessary.

3.2.4.6 Repair diagrams. Repair diagrams and illustrations shall be provided. These diagrams and illustrations shall show all dimensions required for repairs. Such diagrams and illustrations shall consist of patch size, patch overlaps, cover plates, extrusions, stringers, longerons; rivet, bolt, plug, and screw sizes; spacings, edge distances, materials, etc. Sketches shall be included of specific repairs, and repairs typical to the construction of the applicable aircraft, which are not covered in general manuals for structural repair.

3.2.4.7 Major structural components. Illustrations shall be included for the major structural components (wings, stabilizer, etc.) which will provide contour data and dimensions necessary for the construction of templates, support fixtures, and repair jigs for use in repairing the principal components. Where applicable, contour data shall include the list of contour and master dimension drawings.

3.2.4.8 Structural repair kits. Illustrations of structural repair kits (and explanation of the use of each kit) shall be provided, when applicable.

3.2.5 Arrangement. The manual shall be arranged in the following order and the chapters numbered consecutively.

a. Front Matter (see 3.2.5.1)

b. Chapter 1 - General (see 3.2.5.2)

c. Chapter 2 thru n - Separate chapters shall be provided for each of the major structural groups, such as fuselage, empennage, wing, landing gear, engine, etc., as applicable. Separate chapters shall also be provided for peculiar Fuel Tank Sealing and peculiar Radome Repairs (see 3.2.5.3)

d. Chapter n+1 - Damage Due to Landing Gear Failure (see 3.2.5.4)

e. Chapter n+2 - Typical Repairs and Applications (see 3.2.5.5)

f. Chapter n+3 - Repair Materials and Special Tools (see 3.2.5.6)

g. Appendix - Battle Damage Repair (when specified by the acquiring activity, see 3.2.5.7 and 6.2.c)

When these manuals are to be used in conjunction with OMMS prepared in accordance with MIL-DTL-83495, the chapters of major structural groups in the structural repair manuals shall be arranged in SSSN sequence. A separate manual shall be prepared for each chapter. The introduction shall be located in the first manual only.

3.2.5.1 Front matter. In addition to the requirements of MIL-STD-38784, the following is applicable:

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3.2.5.1.1 Introduction. The introduction shall contain a brief explanation of the purpose of the manual and method of application. A statement shall also be included to the effect that use of battle damage repair instructions (when contained in the appendix) shall be restricted to units operating under actual combat conditions. When battle damage instructions are covered in a separate manual, the preceding statement shall appear in the battle damage manual introduction. A series of simple sketches may be used to indicate a method for obtaining the best use from the manual. The introduction shall include a reference to the contractor's "Structural Repair Illustration Document" and a statement where copies can be obtained.

3.2.5.2 Chapter 1, General. The general chapter shall as a minimum contain the following items:

3.2.5.2.1 Description of aircraft. Information relative to the aircraft description, such as: type of construction, materials used, categories of repair capabilities, classification of damage, types of repair, aerodynamic smoothness, principal dimensions, definition of reference lines, and major structural group breakdown.

3.2.5.2.2 Airframe cleaning and finishing. Information relative to cleaning, removal of finishes, and finishing, such as: cleaning procedures and materials required; finishes required on the various areas of the airplane with procedures for application of the finishes; corrosion preventive measures and treatment (see 3.2.1.7); and precautions to be followed in working with the materials.

3.2.5.2.3 Airframe sealing. Information on all areas requiring sealing, type of seal required in each area (using government specifications where applicable), sealing procedures to use, and precautions to be followed in working with the materials. Fuel tank sealing shall be in a separate chapter.

3.2.5.2.4 Pressure testing. Information on pressure testing of sealed compartments wherever such testing will be required after repair to check for leakage of structural integrity.

3.2.5.2.5 Control surface rebalancing. Information for mass rebalancing of all hinged control surfaces by calculated and improvised methods with allowable field tolerances; and instructions covering dynamic rebalancing.

3.2.5.2.6 General shop practices. Information on sheet metal forming; working titanium alloys; installation, removal, and substitution of fasteners equal to or better than those removed; filling dimpled holes; coin dimpling and special tools. Information relative to weld repair that may be accomplished on assemblies which are of welded fabrication. Information on minor unstressed fittings and on castings which are manufactured from weldable materials. Substitute parts and locally manufactured parts shall be identified.

3.2.5.2.7 Crash handling and shipping. Information relative to safety precautions, such as removal of batteries, fuel, oil, liquid oxygen, and explosive activated escape devices (prior to crash handling). Information relative to the equipment, methods, and procedures for lifting and moving damaged aircraft from the crash site. Information about corrosion prevention (see 3.2.1.7) and, where applicable, crating and shipping instructions, which would include crates, cradles, support points, weight, and center of gravity, of each component.

3.2.5.2.7.1 Small, short range, or specialized aircraft. For small, short range, or specialized aircraft, complete aircraft shipping information shall be provided covering disassembly, crating, shipment (mooring), and reassembly with appropriate references to related manuals.

3.2.5.2.8 Damage evaluation. Criteria so that the following inspections may be accomplished:

a. Preliminary external inspection for skin buckles, deformation, etc.

b. Detailed visual inspection information for obvious damaged areas and adjacent areas, including information about critical points and access. Inspection methods and techniques, such as: fire damage inspection using portable testers and primer discoloration; alignment check of the aircraft and of its major assemblies; over "G" and hard landing inspection; corrosion damage (see 3.2.1.7); severe engine stalls; pitch-up or use of drag chute as a spin chute and abnormal drag chute deployment; external pressure testing of items for strength as well as leaks; heat damaged or delaminated honeycomb structure.

c. Identification of those areas requiring structural engineering to develop an acceptable repair.

d. Identification of the nondestructive inspection method to be used to determine the extent of damage, or reference to the applicable nondestructive inspection manual.

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3.2.5.2.9 Support of structure. Required locations for supporting the structure during repair and details for the fabrication and use of supports. All stress plates or stress panels of the aircraft which require shoring or structural supporting prior to removal shall be identified.

3.2.5.2.10 In-service use criteria. Permissible wear and deviation over and above original manufacturing tolerances, critical external surface contour tolerances, reaming and bushing, allowable clearances, and replacement items.

3.2.5.3 Chapter 2 thru n, Repair Chapters. Each repair chapter shall describe the construction of the major assemblies and structural group involved. Wear tolerance charts shall be provided, when applicable, and the negligible damage limits shall be given for each component in the group. One-time flight (ferry) repairs, temporary repairs, and permanent repairs shall also be shown for each component, as applicable. Contour data and dimensions necessary for the construction of templates and repair jigs for use in repairing the principal components shall be provided at the end of each chapter. Peculiar fuel tank sealing and peculiar radome repairs shall be in separate chapters.

3.2.5.4 Chapter n+1, Damage Due To Landing Gear Failure. This chapter shall cover the type of damage resulting from landing gear failure, such as auxiliary gear up, main gear up, all gear up, auxiliary gear tire blowout, main gear tire blowout, and explain the inspections and repair thereof.

3.2.5.5 Chapter n+2, Typical Repairs, and Application. This chapter shall cover typical repairs which are considered applicable to more than one chapter of the manual, i.e., skin patches, extrusion repairs, honeycomb type structures, formed structure repairs, transparent panel repairs, thermal buckling, deformation due to pressurization, trim strip manufacture, and installation requirements for removable panels/doors/hatches/etc.

3.2.5.6 Chapter n+3, Repair Materials, and Special Tools. Tables listing special tools, jigs, templates, leveling tools, etc. shall be given. Tables listing all materials required to make repairs shall be provided. Substitute materials and thicknesses of aluminum, magnesium, titanium, steel, etc. shall be stated. Such tables shall also list specification numbers, part numbers, extrusions by die number, or procurement sources.

3.2.5.7 Appendix, Battle Damage. This appendix shall cover combat area damage and it shall stress the usage of materials requiring relatively unsophisticated fabrication techniques and their application in the restoration of structural integrity of the aircraft. When specified by the acquiring activity (see 6.2.c), battle damage repair shall instead be covered in a separate publication. When issued as a separate manual, both manuals will reference each other according to the requirements in MIL-STD-38784.

3.2.5.8 Additional chapters. When specified by the acquiring activity (see 6.2.d), chapters, in addition to those specified herein, may be added to the manual to permit fulfillment of the intent of this specification. Special charts, tables (such as Tables of Minimum Margins of Safety), or diagrams not specifically required by this specification but considered necessary for a particular type of aircraft shall be included in the manual.

4 VERIFICATION

4.1 Verification requirements. When the technical data produced according to this specification is offered for acceptance, all tests, reviews, and verifications specified by the acquiring activity to determine that it conforms to the requirements in Section 3 of the specification, shall be accomplished as specified (see 6.2.e and 6.6).

4.2 Compliance. Technical Manuals (TMs) shall meet all requirements of Section 3 of this specification and the applicable Digital Support Suite (DSS) appendix, as specified by the acquiring activity (see 6.2). The requirements set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any requirements in this specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of ensuring that all products or supplies submitted to the government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Use of sampling inspections shall be at the discretion of the contractor, and in accordance with commercially acceptable quality assurance procedures. However, use of sampling in QA procedures does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the government to accept defective material.

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5 PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. For acquisition purposes, the packaging requirements shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2.f). When packaging of materiel is to be performed by DoD or in-house contractor personnel, these personnel need to contact the responsible packaging activity to ascertain packaging requirements. Packaging requirements are maintained by the Inventory Control Point's packaging activities within the Military Service or Defense Agency, or within the military service's system commands. Packaging data retrieval is available from the managing Military Department's or Defense Agency's automated packaging files, CD-ROM products, or by contacting the responsible packaging activity.

6 NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature which may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The technical manuals covered by this specification are intended for use by personnel to repair aircraft structures.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.

b. If a separate corrosion control manual is being procured (see 3.2.1.7).

c. If battle damage data will be covered in a separate manual instead of as an appendix to the basic structural repair manual (see 3.2.5).

d. If additional chapters or appendices are required (see 3.2.5.8).

e. The requirements for tests, reviews, and verifications specified for manuals developed under this specification (see 4.1).

f. Packaging requirements (see 5.1).

6.3 Technical manuals. The requirement for technical manuals should be considered when this specification is applied on a contract. If technical manuals are required, specifications and standards that have been authorized and assigned an Acquisition Management Systems Control (AMSC) number must be listed on a separate Contract Data Requirements List (DD Form 1423), which is included as an exhibit to the contract. The technical manuals must be acquired under separate contract line item in the contract.

6.4 Definitions.

6.4.1 Combat area repairs. Repairs that retain the functional capability of the aircraft and are capable of being accomplished in a minimum time, using limited tools, equipment, and materials.

6.4.2 Critical area. An area of the aircraft that is highly stressed, strength or fatigue critical, or that experience has shown to be subject to corrosion and damage in normal usage and which would affect the safety of the aircraft.

6.4.3 Negligible damage. That damage or distortion which can be permitted to exist as in, or corrected by a simple procedure (removing dents, stop drilling cracks, temporary fabric patching, etc.) without placing restrictions on flight and having no impact to strength or service life requirements.

6.4.4 One-time (ferry) flight repair. A repair which restores limited-load-carrying requirements of the member to allow the aircraft to be flown to a depot for permanent repair.

6.4.5 Temporary repair. A repair which restores full-load-carrying requirements of the member, but is deficient either from the standpoint of aerodynamic smoothness or from the interchangeability aspects of the parts involved. At the earliest convenience, each temporary repair is to be removed and a permanent repair installed in its place.

6.5 Subject term (key word) listing.

On-equipment Maintenance Manual Set (OMMS)
Structural group
Symmetry check

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System Subsystem Sub-subsystem Numbering (SSSN)

6.6 TM verification requirements. The Air Force Technical Order Policy and Procedures (AF TOPP) team, AFMC/A4FI, provides the specific requirements for verification of technical data developed and delivered through this specification, as well as guidance for including these requirements in the solicitation or contract (see TO 00-5-3, AF Technical Order Life Cycle Management).

6.7 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this specification are marked with vertical lines to indicate where changes from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the previous issue.

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APPENDIX A
AIRCRAFT STRUCTURAL REPAIR TECHNICAL MANUAL MARKUP LANGUAGE TOOLS

A.1 SCOPE

A.1.1 Scope. This appendix describes the standard Air Force (AF) tagged language digital tools created for developing and delivering AF Technical Manuals (TMs). These tools are available as subsets in the Digital Support Suites (DSS) (see A.2) provided by the AF Technical Manual Specifications and Standards (TMSS) activity. This appendix is a mandatory part of this detail specification. The information herein is intended for compliance.

A.1.2 Template Tool. The DTD is the primary tool that is used as the structure for authoring AF TMs and is based on rules outlined in MIL-HDBK-28001 and ISO 8879. See A.2.1 for information about the DTD specified for this appendix subset.

A.2 DSS

The DSS is comprised of the following tools for authoring and rendering the TM. See A.3 for information about obtaining DSS component files in digital format through the TMSS activity website. For information about the current status of DSS tools, see A.3.4.

A.2.1 DTD. The DTD provides the structure and content template in accordance with the content specific requirements of this specification. To be delivered digitally, the TM shall be tagged using the applicable DTD provided through the TMSS activity. Information concerning the tagged language type and use of DTDs currently provided, i.e., Standardized General Markup Language (SGML), may be obtained through the contacts listed under A.3.

A.2.2 Tag Description Table (TDT). The TDT provides detailed descriptions of the elements contained in the DTD. The TDT contains the element tagging structure, parent elements, full element name, source paragraph for this specification, attribute descriptions unique to the element, and entities.

A.3 OBTAINING DSS TOOLS

A.3.1 Obtaining files by users with .mil website access. The following applies to those interested in obtaining DSS component files who are on a .mil internet domain, having .mil web address access.

A.3.1.1 AF TMSS website. DTDs, TDTs, and other files in the DSS can be accessed on the TMSS website at https://techdata.wpafb.af.mil/tmss/index.html. On the web page, the “Baseline Tools” menu option in the left pane contains two bulleted options called “Specifications & Digital Support Suites (DSSs)” and “Standards & Digital Support Suites (DSSs)”. Hover the cursor over “Specifications & Digital Support Suites (DSSs)” and a listing of the TMSS specifications will appear. Hover over the desired specification and another drop down list will appear that contains an entry indicating the PDF version of the specification and other entries for the associated appendices. To obtain the preferred subset DTD, select the desired appendix from the list. The following items will appear on the downloading page: The name of the specification, the appendix number and name, the current version of the DSS, buttons to download specific DSS files provided and a “Download” button to download the entire DSS zip file.

A.3.2 Obtaining files by users with a Public Key Infrastructure (PKI) certificate or a Common Access Card (CAC). The following applies to those interested in obtaining DSS component files who have a PKI certificate or a CAC:

A.3.2.1 AF TMSS SharePoint website. DTDs, TDTs, and other files in the DSS can be accessed at the AF TMSS SharePoint website: https://usaf.dps.mil/teams/12316/default.aspx.

A.3.3 Obtaining files by users without .mil access, PKI certificate, or CAC. Those seeking to obtain DSS files who do not have .mil web access, a PKI certificate, or a CAC should contact their Government program management office or see A.3.4 to obtain information.

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APPENDIX A

A.3.4 TMSS Helpdesk assistance. Address any requests relating to the DSS by e-mail to SGMLSUPPORT@us.af.mil.

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CONCLUDING MATERIAL

Custodians:
Army - TM
Navy - AS
Air Force - 16

Preparing activity:
Air Force - 16
(Project TMSS-2024-007)

Review activities:
Army - AV
Navy - CG
Air Force - 01, 02, 10, 11, 70, 71, 184

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